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How can industrial design help to better integrate Scandinavian home appliances, increase their perceived value and strengthen user appreciation?

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Abstract

The products that are made for residential environments today often focus on functionality and performance and therefore undermine the importance of aesthetics and how they interact with the actual user. Modern Scandinavia is moving towards a more aesthetically pleasing, minimalistic style with warm earthy tones and a lot of living material and that is most apparent in the Scandinavian homes where furniture and technology is changing their aesthetics towards matching that style. This is where industrial design can play a big part in the future development and better integration in the homes of the Scandinavian people for these appliances.

This thesis was a collaboration with an industry partner and explored how industrial design and its methods can be applied to the future development of home appliances through a user centred and creative design process involving research, ideation and concept development and user feedback. The end result is an early concept of a home appliance that supplies the home with heat and is a central part of many homes today in Scandinavia. This work specifically highlights the importance of making sure these home appliances do not just become a functionality and something that is just made to perform the designated task but rather become a part of the home. As a result, this makes sure the perceived value and user appreciation for the product increases.